

2023/24 Candidate record form, production log and assessment record

Level 3 Extended Project (7993)

Please attach the form to your candidate's work and keep it at the centre or send it to the moderator as required. The declarations should be completed as indicated.

Centre number

Centre name

St Columba's College

Candidate number

Candidate's full name

Henry James McMahon

Work submitted for assessment **must** be the candidate's own. If candidates copy work, allow candidates to copy from them, or cheat in any other way, they may be disqualified.

Candidate declaration

Have you received help/information from anyone **other than** subject teacher(s) to produce this work?

No

Yes (give details below or on a separate sheet if necessary).

Please list below any books, leaflets or other materials (for example DVDs, software packages, internet information) used to complete this work **not** acknowledged in the work itself. Presenting materials copied from other sources **without acknowledgement** is regarded as deliberate deception.

We may use examples of candidate's work for standardisation or training purposes. Please see our privacy notice for more information on how we use assessment data and on your rights under data privacy legislation.

I have read and understood the above. I confirm I produced the attached work without assistance other than that which is acceptable under the scheme of assessment.

Date

Supervisor declaration

I confirm the candidate's work was conducted under the conditions laid out by the specification. I have authenticated the candidate's work and am satisfied, (to the best of my knowledge) that the work produced is solely that of the candidate.

Date

Submission checklist

Candidate number

1066

Candidate's full name

Henry James McMahon

To be completed by the supervisor

Extended Project **working** title

Extended Project **final** title

Form of project

Either written report

Or

and accompanying written report

Is this foundation project part of a group project?

No written report

Yes If 'Yes', give brief details.

Please note that failure to complete or submit a compulsory element may result in a mark of zero being awarded.

Select/tick	Items that must be included	Notes
☐	1. A signed and completed <i>Candidate record form, production log and assessment record</i>	This document. All pages must be completed.
☐	2. Research based written report	If the project product is an artefact or a production, an accompanying research based written report is also required.
☐	3. Evidence of the project product	Eg photographs of artefact, investigation or production; a piece of creative writing (artefact); research based written report.
☐	4. Evidence of a presentation within the production log	Presentation on the project process. Where the project product is itself a presentation (for a specified audience), a presentation on the project process must also be delivered to a non-specialist audience

The taught skills element

To be completed by the supervisor

Candidate number

1066

Candidate's full name

Henry James McMahon

Outline details of taught skills

Record here details of relevant skills taught in a class/group and details of relevant skills taught individually to this candidate as described in the specification. Continue on a separate sheet if necessary.

Record of marks

To be completed by the supervisor

Marks must be awarded in accordance with the instructions and criteria in the specification.

Candidate number

1066

Candidate's full name

Henry James McMahon

Summary information to show how the marks have been awarded should be given in the spaces below in addition to comments in other pages of this document and any supporting information in the form of annotations on the candidate's work.

Skill area	Maximum mark	Mark awarded	Supervisor's supporting statement
A01 Manage	10		
A02 Use resources	10		
A03 Develop and realise	20		
A04 Review	10		
Total mark	50	0	

Supervisor's concluding comments**Internal moderation comments if appropriate****Supervisor declaration**

I confirm that no work assessed for the award of the marks above is also to be submitted, or has been submitted, for any other accredited qualification(s).

Date

Record of initial ideas**To be completed by the candidate**

This page records initial meeting(s) with your supervisor to agree your project ideas. Additional pages can be submitted if more than one idea has been explored.

My idea(s) for topic/title

Computer science has always fascinated me, and Artificial Intelligence is an area of particular interest to me due to its growing significance particularly to our generation. Beginning my EPQ I knew I wanted to answer a question regarding the future of AI. To answer a question along these lines I started to research what was topical in this area. As a result, I considered titles such as:

- The future of AI in warfare. (topical due to what is happening in Ukraine)
- How should AI be adopted within education? (topical due to the many instances of chat GPT usage in schoolwork)
- How should Governments of the world regulate AI? (topical due to the upcoming Bletchley Park summit and the EU's AI act that was repeatedly being mentioned in media)

From these question's I decided that the one that interested me the most and, had the most relevant media surrounding it was the question regarding regulation. My interest about regulation specifically comes from my belief that AI is the technological revolution that our generation will witness, as it develops further, I believe that regulation is of key importance to society if we are to harness the power of AI for good.

My ideas for research and development of my project

I aim to gain a broad understanding of AI in this project; therefore, I plan to research AGI (Artificial General Intelligence) also known as strong AI. I plan this because I believe AGI will be the biggest challenge facing regulators due to its self-improvement abilities. I also plan to research the types of AI that are currently being utilised, this is because they will be key to my understanding. Of AGI as well as my understanding of the current issues that regulators face. Finally, I plan to research the future types of AI and their associated regulation.

My summary of the comments and advice from my supervisor

My supervisor advised that I should look more generally at AI regulation and instead of having a concrete topic of new regulation. I should instead look more broadly at current legislation in place as well as legislation that currently relates to AI.

Modifications I have made as a result of my discussion with my supervisor

As a result of the comments from my supervisor, I have broadened the scope of my title from "How should the Governments of the world regulate AI?" to "What risk does AI pose to society?". This question is broader as it also looks at the social response to AI in many fields as well as the fanatical impact of AI. I prefer this question for my EPQ because it allows for more exploration for the wider effects of AI on society.

Candidate number

1066

Candidate's full name

Henry James McMahon

Date 26/11/2023

Part A: Candidate proposal

To be completed by the candidate

Working title of my Extended Project.

Present the topic to be researched in the form of a short statement/question/hypothesis with clear focus.

What risk does AI pose to society?

- my initial resources will be

I plan to demonstrate an understanding of the types of AI currently available. I will do this primarily through the IBM(International Business Machines) YouTube channel with a playlist on the fundamentals of AI. I chose IBM because it is an industry leading and trustworthy source with excellent video essays. (<https://ibm.com/>, <https://www.youtube.com/playlist?list=PLOspHqNVtKADfxkuDuHduUkDExBpEt3DF>)

To gain an understanding of the legislation that the UK Government is planning to produce, I will use the legislation.gov.uk site. This is because they are the sole publishers of legislation and legislation plans for the Houses of Parliament and they are therefore the most trustworthy source. (<https://www.legislation.gov.uk/>)

To build an understanding of the laws that the EU Parliament is developing and planning on passing, I will use the European parliament website (<https://www.europarl.europa.eu/>) as well as the dedicated AI Act's website (<https://artificialintelligenceact.eu/>). I chose these two sources on account that they directly publish the legislation from the EU Parliament to the public and therefore are trustworthy.

For my economic statistics, I plan to use Goldman Sachs investment bank articles. I have chosen them because they are experts in the field of economic predictions, due to the nature of their work and therefore are a trustworthy source.

For predicting the future capabilities of AI, I plan on using a variety of news sources including the BBC, NBC as well as IBM. I believe all these sources trustworthy however they may be slightly biased and therefore I must use many sources to build and accurate picture of the future advancements of AI.

- the courses of study or area(s) of personal interest to which the topic relates

Artificial Intelligence greatly intrigues me, I believe it to be the technological revolution of our generation and I am extremely excited to witness its progression. Simply the idea of machines imitating human intelligence fascinates me. However, this excitement is not shared through society and many individuals are in fact scared by this rapid progress.

To me, regulations are the primary tool at the disposal of government for this fear to be tamed. I believe if governments have a complete understanding of AI fundamentals. They will be able to write comprehensive regulations that place responsibility on developers for the results that their AI's produce. These regulations will also advance research into AI so that overall safety standards within the industry will be improved.

The method by which this is achieved is also of particular interest to me. This is because an AI that does everything the user asks i.e. gives advice on illegal activity, is inherently dangerous. As a result further research into strengthening AI against immoral activities must be made so that AI can have an understanding of morals just like people do.

Candidate number

1066

Candidate's full name

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- my intended product

I plan to write an essay of approximately 5000 words that will evaluate the need for government regulation of AI. To produce this, I will need to cover two main areas: what is AI i.e. "How it works?" and "What have current governments done to regulate AI?". I foresee the understanding of the fundamentals of AI to be a complex task I therefore intend on producing a notes document to sum up my understanding. This document of notes will then be used to produce my section on what AI is.

I plan to download and populate an Excel Gantt chart to aid me in building an understanding of the format of my essay which will additionally allow me to allocate deadlines for key points in my essay. These deadlines will be vital to keeping my project on track and avoiding procrastination. I also intend on regularly updating my EPQ log with ideas and plans as well as notes. I will be doing this as a redundancy, in case the Gantt chart or notes fail me so that I will have a backup.

I hope to create a presentation with a supporting PowerPoint at the end of my project which I will then deliver to an audience. This will highlight key stages within my planning and writing process including the issues I faced and how I overcame them.

Provide details of the courses that you are currently studying

Qualification Type	Awarding body & Subject
Eg GCSE, Modern Apprenticeships, BTEC	Eg AQA Mathematics, OCR Computing, WJEC English
A-level	Computer Science (AQA)
A-level	Mathematics (Edexcel)
A-level	Physics (OCR A)

Notice to candidate You must not take part in any unfair practice in the preparation of project work required for assessment and you must understand that to present material copied directly from any book or any other sources without acknowledgement will be regarded as deliberate deception. If you use or attempt to use any unfair practice you will be reported to AQA and you may be disqualified from **all** subjects.

Candidate declaration

I certify that I have read and understood AQA's Regulations relating to unfair practice as set out in the notice to candidates above.

Date 30/11/2023

Part B: Supervisor's comments on candidate proposal**To be completed by the supervisor**

Please comment below on the validity and feasibility of the candidate proposal (Part A) as an Extended Project

	Supervisor's comments
Indicate the relation to, and development/extension outside of, the main course(s) of study or interest	Although the candidate is taking Computer Science A level, his subject leader has confirmed this is not part of his syllabus. The topic builds on the interests of the candidate.

Candidate number

1066

Candidate's full name

Henry James McMahon

Comment on the suitability of the proposed initial sources and research base

There is a good range of sources identified.

Confirm that the project is feasible in the proposed timescale and/or indicate any potential difficulties that may prevent the candidate from meeting the assessment objectives

This is a feasible project. We have discussed that the candidate should set himself a definite deadline after which he will not look for new information in order to allow himself time to write up his project.

Indicate the expected format of the project product that will be submitted for assessment

Research based written report

Artefact (for example prototype, model, artwork, scientific investigation, creative writing) plus written report

Is the project a contribution to a group exercise? YES NO

If Yes, confirm that there is a defined individual contribution by the candidate YES NO

List the **other** group members below.

Date 30/11/2023

Part C: Centre coordinator's approval of candidate proposal

Supervisor's name

M James

To be completed by the centre coordinator

If you are acting as both the Centre coordinator and the supervisor, please seek counter signature from a senior colleague

Candidate number

1066

Candidate's full name

Henry James McMahon

Centre coordinator's comments on the feasibility and acceptability of the proposal (parts A & B) as an Extended Project

This is an interesting and topical proposal.

Approved

Approved subject to the implementation of
the centre coordinator's recommendations

Resubmission required

Centre coordinator's name

M James

Date 30/11/2023

Planning review

To be completed by the candidate

This page records your outline plan once your proposal has been approved.

My next steps in planning, researching and deadlines that I will set myself. What I intend to do, by when, what resources I will use and how I will implement the recommendations of the centre co-ordinator (where appropriate).

Questions I aim to answer:

Research questions:

- 1) What is AI?
- 2) What are the different models for AI?
- 3) What makes an effective AI?
- 4) Uses and applications of AI now and in the future.
- 5) UK government Twelve essential challenges that AI governance must tackle.
- 6) Discrimination (case studies)

Deep fakes (AI generated videos):

- 1) How those risks are currently being mitigated.

Discussion questions:

- 1) Is the current legal system effective against unethical use of AI?
- 2) To what extent can AI be fairly utilized in legal processes such as prosecution of criminals?
- 3) Is enough being done to fairly replace jobs with AI? (Is it right to replace jobs with AI?) (What will happen to the job market with introduction of AI)
- 4) Do economic systems need to change to fairly introduce AI to society?

I have read multiple articles online about AI and its regulation which has informed me of the questions I wish to answer above. I have written the following notes on these articles:

,

My summary of the comments and advice from my supervisor

I need to format the goals above into a planning document (Excel Gantt chart) including dates attached to each of my goals for when I expect to achieve each goal by. This will help me evaluate the time frame in which the tasks above must be completed. Furthermore, once completed I will have a better understanding of each task. Therefore, I will be able to logically place them into my schedule so that research from previous tasks can be integrated into current tasks. This will ensure my final essay flows with information from previous sections being integrated with information in the later sections.

Candidate number

1066

Candidate's full name

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Modifications I have made as a result of my discussion with my supervisor and/or the comments from my centre coordinator

I have downloaded a Gantt chart template for Microsoft Excel and populated the activities list including the five definition questions and the other tasks listed above. I have also allocated weeks in which I wish to complete each task. This is in conjunction with estimated lengths of each task which for now I have decided will be a week each. I have decided this because I still have some time before end of year exams meaning I have some capacity in addition to the two EPQ sessions per week and Thursday study periods P4/P5 which I plan to use for the EPQ. furthermore, due to the distance until end of year exams I believe I can spare the time for the EPQ outside of my studies.

Date 23/02/2024

Mid-project review

To be completed by the candidate

This page records your outline plan when you have completed your research.

Is my project following my original plan? How has my plan developed?

For my project so far I have followed my plan and I have answered 3 out of the 5 original definition questions. These were primarily completed with the use of my notes from the IBM YouTube series on fundamentals of AI. I chose IBM to be my source for these sections as they are an industry leading and reputable source of information.

However, during the Easter break I chose to take the opportunity to complete my Duke of Edinburgh Gold residential instead of completing it during summer holidays. Which has put me behind schedule according to my Gantt chart, however, I will now have more time during the summer holidays to complete my EPQ. Recognising this I have made some changes to the time frame and subsequently the structure of my essay. I plan to keep my original goal of reviewing AI and its regulation however I now plan to add in an ethics portion to my EPQ to better answer my question. I am making this change because I have found while I have a solid foundation in AI I am struggling to understand its specific legislation, and by better understanding the ethics surrounding AI I will be able to better understand and assess the legislation. This will eventually result in a more articulate project.

Candidate number

1066

Candidate's full name

Henry James McMahon

My summary of the comments and advice from my supervisor

I need to modify my Gantt chart so that it factors in the time I have for my EPQ. I need to edit my goals in my Gantt chart to better follow my revised route that includes the ethics section. Additionally, I must change my title so that it reflects this change in structure (addition of ethics section). It was also suggested that due to end of year (EOY) exams coming up in June, I should assess my time provision for the EPQ given the fact it recommended to priorities EOY exam preparation during the months leading up to them.

Modifications I have made as a result of my discussion with my supervisor at this stage

I have since added a task on my main Gantt chart for researching and writing my ethics sections. I plan that this will take around two weeks to complete due to the breadth of viewpoints on the issue. I have scheduled time to do this in between the end of exams and the start of summer holidays. This will allow me to research and write the ethics section and then begin summer holidays for a few weeks giving time for the ethics section to be properly understood in my mind.

I will then be starting the case studies sections later in the summer holidays. I will start this with a fresh mind allowing me to more fairly review the legislation of both case studies. which will result in a less biased and more rigid conclusion of the legislation.

My amended Gantt chart can be seen below:

My final title and agreed form of project product

Artificial Intelligence, the ethical challenges that it presents and how Governments have and should approach its regulation?

My planned next steps to complete my project

I plan to research into the ethics that surround AI. Specifically, consumers and developers with an initial focus on consumers since they are the end users of AI. My sources for this section will primarily consist of news articles from long standing and reputable news agencies. I have chosen this to be my source of information due to, the limited relevant reports on the current ethics of AI in academic journals, (as AI is current and constantly evolving). However, I believe I will produce valid points by slightly expanding my range of sources to account for the slightly higher probability of bias in news articles compared to academic journals.

After researching this I will write a section on how AI can be unethical as well as the many individual ethical concerns. This is then to be followed by the specific ethical considerations that should be made by Governments in their new legislation. By having these sections written I will have a better understanding of the considerations that need to be made.

In light of this I will then go on to review the EU and the UK's approach to AI regulation. I intend on using the official EU and UK websites respectively for reporting on their legislation. I believe that this approach to resource gathering for my case studies will be as un-biased as possible since I will be interpreting the legislation directly.

I envisage that by taking this approach I will be more informed when reviewing the case studies rather than reviewing the case studies then researching the ethical considerations. I plan this because by having a solid understanding of the ethics of AI my criteria for assessment will be more structured and therefore less biased.

I aim to complete a section on the future of AI and how regulators should approach the issues presented by an ever-changing technology. Then I will write the conclusion to my project to sum up the key points discussed. I envisage also writing an evaluation of my project which will assess the key points made in this project.

Date 20/03/2024

Candidate number

1066

Candidate's full name

Henry James McMahon

Project product review

To be completed by the candidate

This page records the (near) completion of your project product. Outline the successes, failures, additions and/or changes you made as you followed the plan in your mid-project review

Did my project follow my revised plan (from the mid-project review)?

Overall, yes, my project has followed my revised plan. Since the mid project review, I have researched and written the sections on ethical concerns and legislation in the EU and UK. I have also written a section on the future methodologies and capabilities of AI. In addition to the regulatory challenges that this may present to regulators. I have also written the conclusion and evaluation of my project ahead of the revised schedule. Since this allows me to focus on preparing for year 13 which will leave me more time closer to the final deadline for making final additions to the project, as well as putting together my final presentation.

My summary of the comments and advice from my supervisor at this final stage

I must produce a bibliography on the final project, which can be done by looking back in my notes and copying across my sources into the bibliography. I must also focus over the next few days on practicing my presentation to both myself and my family, since I plan on not using cue cards.

Modifications I have made as a result of discussion with my supervisor at this final stage

Do I need to do anything else to complete my product?

I have produced a combined bibliography and list of references that I have populated by looking back in my notes and finding the links to a few news articles that I have read but not included in the final project. I have also began practicing my presentation to my family and will continue to do so.

Date 17/04/2024

Presentation record part A

To be completed by the candidate

This page records your presentation and its preparation.

Planned format of my presentation (eg timing, audience, use of visual aids, slides, use of notes, etc.)

I plan to produce a 10-minute presentation on my project, the issues I faced and what I have learnt. I aim to use no visual aids or cue cards. Instead, I will rely solely on my PowerPoint presentation and my practice to prompt me during the presentation. I chose this format because often people tend to focus on cue cards too much when public speaking and subsequently can detract from the overall meaning of a presentation. Therefore, not having them and practicing more seems a great opportunity for me to improve my presentation and public speaking skills.

Planned content of my presentation

I plan to break my presentation into four main sections with the following slides in each:

Initial objective and reason for my question

- Aims and objectives
- Why I chose the subject?

My project breakdown and conclusion

- My question (a breakdown of it)
- Key areas covered and the sources used
- Key considerations regarding the regulation of AI
- Project conclusion

Evaluation of my project

- Assessment of the completion of my aim
- What I learnt during my EPQ

The future

- What I will do differently next time
- How does my EPQ affect my future

This structure will encapsulate all the points I wish to cover during my presentation. By the end of the presentation, I believe that I will have covered all necessary content for the audience to understand the process that I took to produce my EPQ. As well as having a clear picture as to the content within my project and what sources were used to produce that content.

Candidate number

1066

Candidate's full name

Henry James McMahon

Modifications I have made as a result of rehearsal and/or discussion with my supervisor

I have added a slide for what I plan to cover on my PowerPoint, since this will help the audience gauge what they will learn during the presentation from the beginning. My supervisor also advised that I continue to practice my presentation to myself and others. Which I have now done and will continue to do

Date 17/08/2024

Presentation record part B

To be completed by the supervisor

Record and comment below on the delivery of the presentation

	Supervisor's record/comments
The nature of the audience (include numbers of staff, students and others present)	
The nature of the presentation (include use of notes, use of display items, and use of presentation software)	
Comment on the content and delivery of the presentation (for example clarity of ideas, structure of presentation, pace, engagement with audience)	

Candidate number

1066

Candidate's full name

Henry James McMahon

Comment on the response of the candidate to questions that demonstrated understanding and grasp of the project and/or its production. **Give examples of questions asked and answers given.**

Date

Summary and reflection

To be completed by the candidate

This page records your summary, reflection and evaluation when you have completed your project product and given your presentation.

Some questions you may wish to answer in this section include, what have I learned from completing this project? What new knowledge or expertise have I enjoyed or found valuable? What are the strengths and weaknesses of my project (including planning and organisation)? What skills have I improved? What changes would I make if I undertook such work again? What advice would I give to others undertaking such a project?

Reflecting on my entire EPQ, I feel I have developed and realised numerous skills that will be useful for completing research projects of a similar scale in future:

- Analytical skills – reading multiple sources of information and finding underlying trends that surround one or more issues.
- Research gathering – navigating the internet to find reputable sources or finding multiple sources on the same issue.
- Documentation of research – writing clear and concise notes on articles/ video-essays that I can quickly refer back to/ use at a later date.
- Time management – effectively using my time to research or write specific sections of my essay.
- Schedule adaptability – effectively assessing my project's schedule for its compatibility with my other commitments, and only modifying it only when necessary.
- Discipline/ resilience – sticking to goals that I have set myself and understanding that procrastination will only lead to poorer outcomes.
- Word processing – laying out a large document logically with contents page and references/ bibliography that can update automatically using the inbuilt tools that word has to offer.

I found researching into the different paradigms of AI to be the most interesting portion of my project. It was eye opening to find out that IBM built "deep blue" the chess bot back in 1995. Furthermore, it was fascinating to see the advancement that were made during the "deep blue" project, are still used to this day in a variety of unforeseen applications.

I found that my strengths during my EPQ were:

- Commitment – I was consistently working towards my project's final goal, and I never found myself in a situation where cramming of work was needed.
- Good organisation – from the beginning I had a folder dedicated to my EPQ that I could access from all my devices, this allowed me to work on my EPQ without a long setup process. It also assured me that I would never lose any work that I had done, which helped me stay motivated.
- Resource variety – I found I spent a lot of time from the start of the project reading a wide variety of resources. I then consistently noted my findings in the EPQ folder, and this really helped me pick a subject that had the relevant resources and that suited my interests.
- Documentation of notes – Upon reading consistently copied the links to my sources and the dates accessed into my notes documents.
- Choice of subject – I feel even more interested in my EPQ title, now having completed the project. Which indicates to me that I chose an appropriate area of interest.

I found that my weaknesses during my EPQ were:

- Depth of early planning – I struggled to build a definite plan for my essay from the start. This was due to my initial lack of building breadth of knowledge in my title. However, I believe I corrected this as I improved the title and scope of my essay during the process of project realisation.
- Planning of essay structure – I believe I was too quick to begin research into my decided sections of my essay and instead it would have been beneficial to research more broadly into my titles sub-topics. This would have been beneficial as it would have given me the opportunity to spot the need for an ethics section sooner.

- Depth of final essay – I feel I could have narrowed the scope of my essay further focusing on a specific area of regulation i.e. “the environmental impact of consumer AI” and drawing a more closed conclusion. However, I do believe my conclusion to be properly informed by my research included in my essay.
- Documentation in my final log – While I believe that the documentation of my notes was excellent. I feel it would have been beneficial for this documentation, to have made its way to my log at an earlier stage in my project. So that I wouldn't have had to compile this close to the end.
- Referencing in my final document – while I feel that the referencing in my final essay meets expectations. I believe I could have saved myself work, by putting my references in as I was writing. Instead of having to refer back to my notes, to populate my references and bibliography in the final stages.

Reflecting on my entire project I believe my greatest strength was my passion for the question I was answering. This passion is what lead me through the difficult stages of my EPQ, allowing me to have a whole knowledge of my subject matter. This would indicate that my greatest skill was commitment to the project which has significantly helped me to further develop key skill such as organising and planning a project this scale. Approaching a project of this scale in future, I would strive to use these improved skills to their fullest potential. I would do this by, emphasising breadth of knowledge in subject matter to inform the early planning stages of the research and essay.

My advice for future candidates undertaking the EPQ:

- Breadth of research from the beginning – Having breadth of knowledge in your topic arear is key to producing an accurate and informed plan for the EPQ.
- Referencing as you go along – Be sure when writing the essay to reference your sources as you go along, this will save you the process of going back in the essay and finding the references in your notes.
- Documenting all changes to original plans in the log – This will assist you in reaching those top marks in each band as well as giving you better opportunity to reflect on your progress.
- Non relevant research – Having breadth of knowledge in your subject will be key to avoiding spending time researching information that is not directly relevant. This is because you will find it easier to assess the significance of researching certain concepts in relation to the answering of your question.
- Use of a scheduling software that is intuitive/ familiar – While I feel that my amended Gantt chart was useful during project realisation. I believe that I could have worked better by using a more intuitive system that perhaps offers far more colours for the tasks, this would have been more useful particularly for planning around other commitments (that would have been denoted by different colours).

My final advice for future candidates would be to persevere with the EPQ as it has measurable benefits in both academic and personal development. While it may seem daunting to approach a task of this size, it is extremely rewarding, and I would highly recommend it.